Sam Gillette

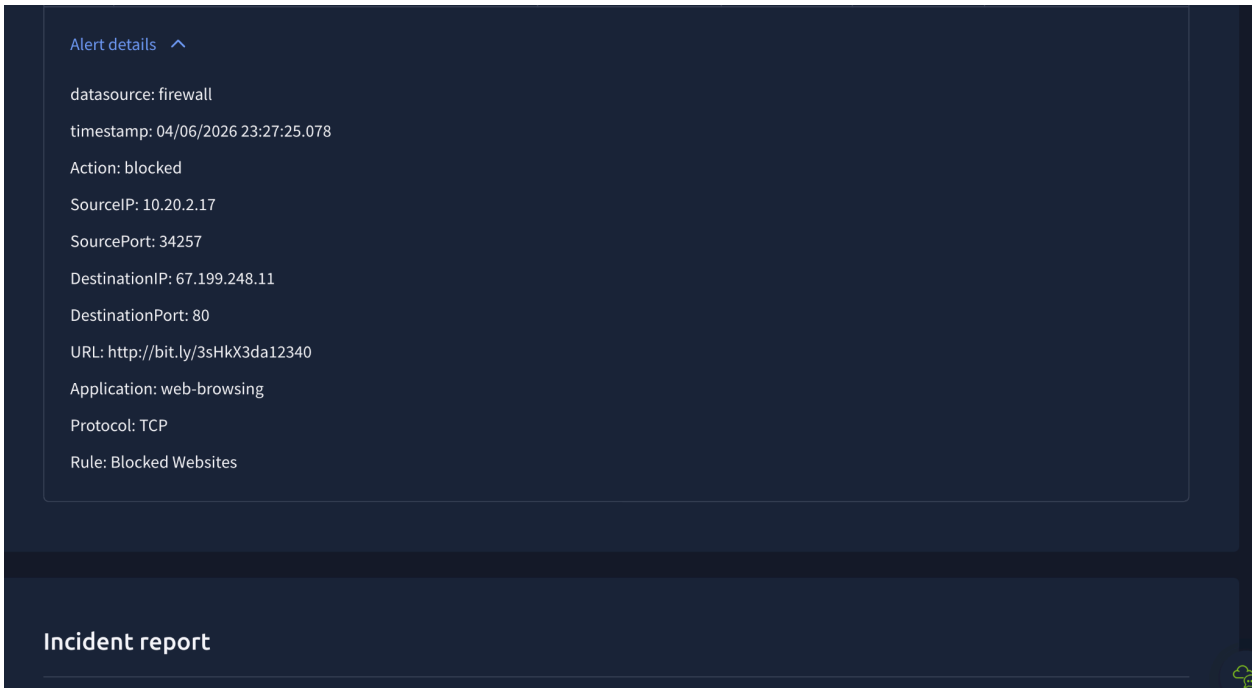
Phishing Simulation

04/06/2026

Summary:

In this simulation, I took on the role of a L1 SOC Analyst handling real security alerts. My job was to read the alert and decide if it was a true positive or a false positive. After that I needed to write a report that contained the Time of Activity, List of Affected Entities, My reason for classifying as a True Positive, My reason for escalation, my recommendation for mitigation, and List of Attack Indicators.

Suspicious URL Alert: True Positive



Time of activity: 04/06/2026 23:27:25.078

List of Affected Entities: 10.20.2.17

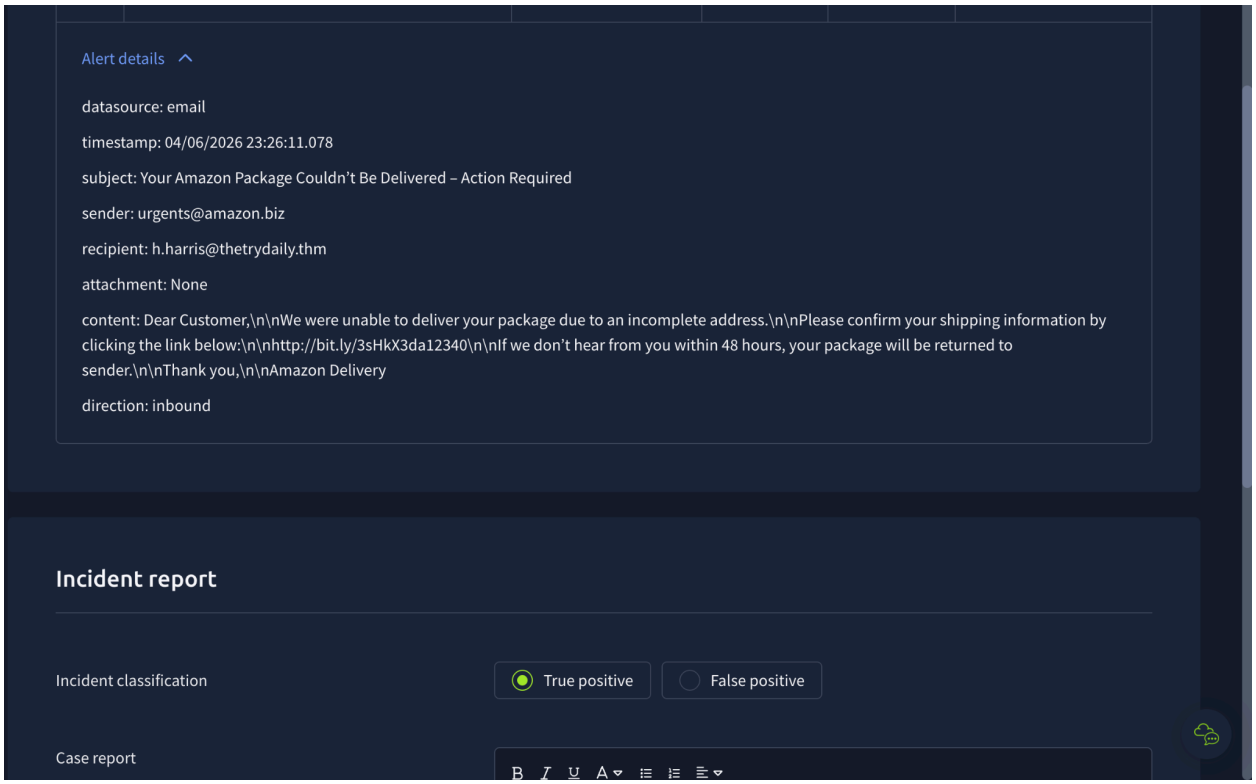
Reason for Classifying as True Positive: The Source IP attempted to make a connection with the Destination IP of 67.199.248.11. This is bit.ly. Bitly is a popular link management and URL shortening platform that converts long, complex web addresses (URLs) into short, easy-to-share links. This website is blocked because it can hide malicious links.

Reason for Escalating the Alert: I'm escalating this alert because it appears a user may be trying to shorten their links.

Recommended Remediation Actions: Run an EDR scan on the user to ensure there are no persistent threats on the machine.

List of Attack Indicators: Suspicious URL being blocked by a firewall.

Phishing Alert #1: True Positive



Time of activity: 04/06/2026 23:26:11.078

List of Affected Entities: h.harris@thetrydaily.thm

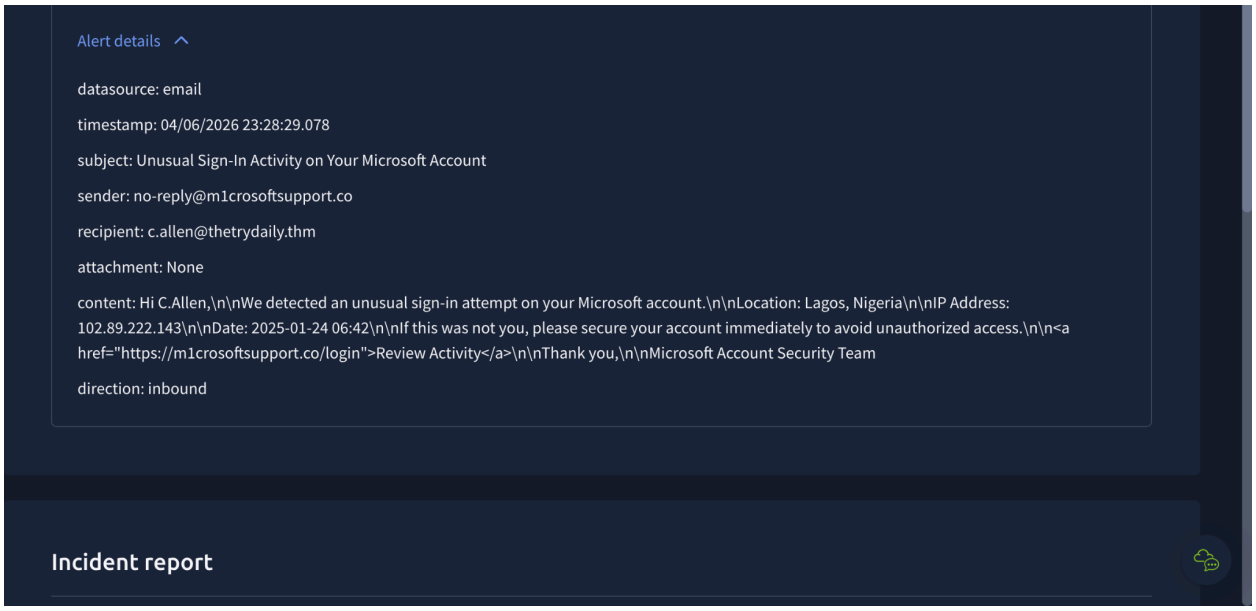
Reason for Classifying as True Positive: I classified this as a true positive due to the Brand Impersonation that is happening here. The sender's email is urgents@amazon.biz. They are using both brand impersonation and urgency to get the target to click their link.

Reason for Escalating the Alert: The reason I am escalating this alert is that it relates to the last alert, where a user attempted to shorten their malicious links. This requires further investigation.

Recommended Remediation Actions: Filtering emails and training employees are two great ways to prevent phishing attacks like this. If you filter emails, you can filter out some of the phishing attacks, stopping them before they even reach a human. If you educate employees, you can ensure that they do not click on malicious links.

List of Attack Indicators: Use of Urgency and impersonating Amazon.

Account Compromise: True Positive

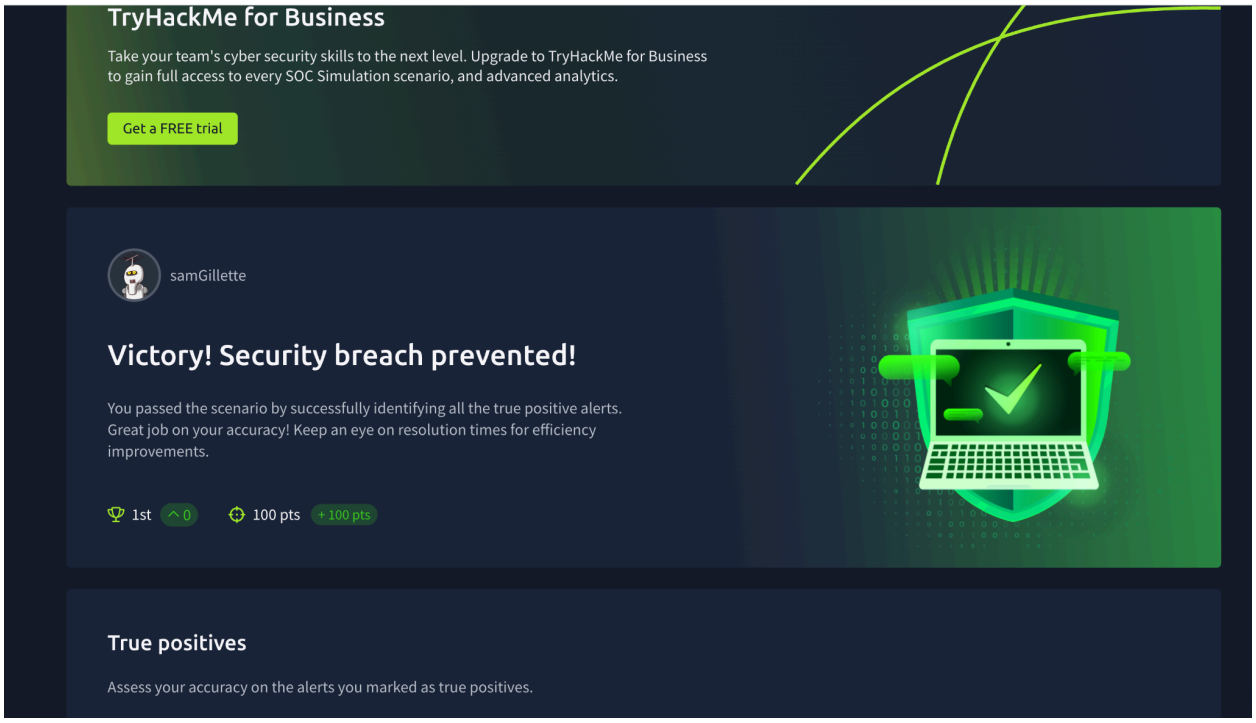


Time of activity: 04/06/2026 23:28:29.078

List of Affected Entities: c.allen@thetrydaily.thm

Reason for Classifying as True Positive: This is Microsoft alerting C Allen that his account has had an unusual sign-in. This needs to be investigated further to see if there is a compromise in the account.

Reason for Escalating the Alert: This needs to be escalated further because it is suspicious that C Allen had an unusual login to their account. It could be an IoC for their account.

Recommended Remediation Actions: Multi-Factor Authentication is a great way to prevent someone from compromising accounts.

List of Attack Indicators: Unusual Login Activity which can be an IoC for a compromised account.